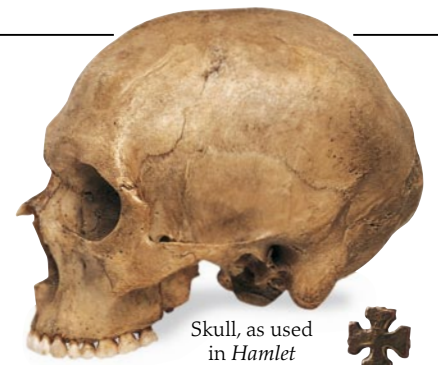




GRAVE TROUBLE

The trapdoor in the stage allowed players to disappear and appear suddenly. The hole in the floor was also used to represent a grave. In this scene from a production of *Hamlet* at the modern Globe in London, it is the grave of Ophelia. Hamlet and Ophelia's brother Laertes have jumped into the grave, both grief-stricken. They start to fight and have to be pulled apart.

Candle, often carried by a player dressed in a nightgown



Skull, as used in *Hamlet*

USEFUL PROPS

With little scenery, props were used for visual effect, to create atmosphere, and to help set the scene. Skulls appear in several tragedies, where characters gaze at them and talk about death. A crown was an important prop in history plays, which deal mostly with struggles for the throne. Candles carried onto the stage told the audience that it was night.



Royal crown



Each player put his head through a hole in the table



The table surrounded by a curtain to hide what is underneath

Ruff was placed around the player's neck after he had put his head through the hole in the table



The actor had to be careful not to blink or move